



FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 19

LOUISIANA

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Louisiana's family courts and child-welfare system.

37

LOUISIANA FAMILIES ON RECORD · 61
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 27 MONTHS
MEDIAN TIME IN SYSTEM

REPORT GENERATED
APRIL 20, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
10 OF 64

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

LOUISIANA AT A GLANCE.

Across 37 Louisiana families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 61 24 of 37 families reporting with kids	MEDIAN ATTORNEY FEES \$15,000 per reporting family	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 27 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 51.4% 32.4% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 37	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 2.5	REPORTING FAMILIES 24 of 37	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 10

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Louisiana families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

02 THE COST OF LOUISIANA FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	25	\$15,000	\$63,340	\$1,583,500
Lost Wages	19	\$20,000	\$81,498	\$1,548,461
Other Court Fees	14	\$1,500	\$3,893	\$54,501
Therapy / Evaluations	20	\$1,750	\$5,865	\$117,291
Reunification Services	13	\$0	\$1,052	\$13,681
GAL Fees	16	\$0	\$1,656	\$26,501
Asset Loss ¹	18	\$52,500	—	—
Estimated Median Family Impact	—	\$90,750	—	—

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$52,500) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost		27	2.2 yrs
Mean months lost		42	3.5 yrs
Total across all families		1,167	97.2 yrs

03 WHO IS REPORTING · LOUISIANA

Most families documenting in Louisiana are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Currently involved / "S...		9	24%
I am currently stuck in ...		9	24%
Case closed (more tha...		2	5%
I am currently in an act...		2	5%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Family Court Only		15	41%
Both Family Court and ...		12	32%
CPS (Child Protective ...		3	8%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		9	24%
3 – 5 years		8	22%
5 – 10 years		7	19%
1-3 years		5	14%
6 months – 1 year		4	11%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Los...		13	35%
Visitation Only		9	24%
Children in Foster Care		8	22%
50/50 Joint		4	11%
Partial / Shared		1	3%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Jefferson		3	8%
Ouachita		3	8%
Beauregard		2	5%
Rapides		2	5%
Acadia		1	3%
Acadiana		1	3%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Acc...		10	27%
False Accusations CPS...		9	24%
Other: (Short answer)		6	16%
High Conflict Divorce		2	5%
Judicial Abuse / Retali...		2	5%

05 PARENT VOICES — LOUISIANA

Quotes appear as submitted. Long submissions are trimmed with [...] to fit the page; the full unedited quote is available in the online version of this report.



Destroyed my faith in a fair legal system

— AMY

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

EBR family court has. Profited off of Children's lives being sold here in Baton Rouge to the highest bidder ever since I was a child in this same system. Unethical, unconstitutional, no rights of due process, false imprisonment, deprivation of equal protection clause, civil [...]

— LOUISIANA PARENT · PRISCILLA

MORE VOICES FROM LOUISIANA

Destroyed my marriage by painting us against each other and promising him ine things like custody and creating lies to start troubles. Thry dont want families together they want to destroy lives. Theres nonreunification. The system is designed one way. They win. And we are [...]

— LAUREN

Family court has destroyed my life, my family, and my income!

— STEVEN

This system has ripped my family apart. Now, I grieve the loss of my children while they are still living.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Split us apart,brainwash and alienate my children. Destroyed a whole family.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

"What was supposed to protect my family instead fractured it—turning unproven allegations into real consequences for me and my children."

— PEPPER

Destroyed my family. Ruined our lives.

— LAUREN

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Make it make sense I can't make this shit yo if I tried

— NICOLE

My son and daughter abused, complete alienation from 16 yr old, they gave a bio dad more rights then me and he hurt child , no vetting or back grounds , still gets more and alot of ailinating.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Contemplated murder and suicide. Left me totally alone and unable to cope. Focusing on basic needs of survival. Mistreated by society

— KELLY

I have experienced emotional, financial, legal, and mental abuse with coercive control over my child. More importantly my child has experienced emotional and mental abuse from the same situation.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Left me suicidal and wishing I could have taken matters in hand in the beginning and never gotten involved with the legal system. One or two good come to Jesus meetings and we all could have moved on happily.

— KELLY

My life is numb. I'm lost. My soul is in constant pain. My family will never be whole again.

— ANGIE

Stole everything, my life, my sanity, my happiness. Destroyed everything.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has casued me to lose custody of my son. An my marriage is coming to an end behind this as well.

— CHRISTINE

My biological daughter was taken from me and placed with a non-biological caregiver. This case has devastated my life and my family. My youngest daughter has not seen her sister since she was a baby. I lost another pregnancy due to the extreme stress of this situation.

— ADREYON

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



This beyond “cruel” situation, (instead) had “weaponized” our Injury Trial “Settlement”, to deny my son his essential “continuing care”, that he continued (for years) to be assured to receive, that suddenly instead has expedited his expiration date!

— RUSSELL

This system has beaten and destroyed the mental health of 6 very healthy people before them. I have had to watch my babies beg me to save them and couldn't do anything. My son is mad and blamed me for leaving because he doesn't understand. I went from 2 times a week visits to [...]

— TIFFANIE NICOLE

The family has robbed my children not only of their mother and extended family, but their siblings. They've missed out on so much and have been nonstop brainwashed

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

it has damn never killed me time I will never get back. put stuff on me all most un respable to complete it's sad sick it's a night near in my dreams at night scared to enjoy life they watching trying to find something on me

— TIFFANY

As the nonoffending parent, I was deprived of 10 years of a relationship with my son so he could be in Hidden Foster Care. He missed out on entire 1st, 2nd, and 3rd grades because the state did not ensure he was in school. It will have lifelong impacts.

— MICHAEL W.

The system is completely destroyed my life, my family and daughter. My ex picked up from school on April 17, 2023 and has never slept back in her home with me since then. She was four years old and I have missed every holiday and every school event because I cannot go. This is [...]

— BRITNEY

23 Louisiana parents submitted ranked quotes. 23 appear in this report; the remainder are available at standwithmeg.com/la.

06 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Louisiana report comes from Louisiana respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Louisiana — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 37 Louisiana families reporting here are not the universe of Louisiana families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – April 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics (email + name + submission date) are applied before aggregation. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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